

NGL™
EVERY SPORT STARTS HERE

NGL SCHOOLS

Gymnastics in your school
The sport that powers every sport

Why gymnastics, why NGL Schools, how it continues into secondary school, and two ways to run it in your school: led by your own teachers, or as an after-school club that costs your school nothing.

For headteachers and PE leads · 2026–27 school year
National Gymnastics League · nationalgymnasticsleague.co.uk

SECTION 1

Why gymnastics

Every sport starts here. Gymnastics teaches children to **jump, land, roll, balance, turn and control their body**. Football, rugby, netball, swimming and dance are all built on those movements, so a child who does gymnastics is ready for every other sport they try.

49%
of children in England get the recommended hour of activity a day

28%
manage less than 30 minutes a day

6
levels, each one achievable, from first shapes to handstands

3
routines at every level: floor, bench and vault

What children develop

Skill	How NGL Schools builds it
Strength	Front, back and side supports, press-ups, burpees, holding the body in a handstand
Balance	Single-leg and arabesque balances, walking and turning on a bench
Flexibility	Straddle, pike, bridge and splits
Coordination and agility	Jumps, turns, rolls, cartwheels and vaults off a springboard
Body control, safe landing	A taught landing position at every level, so children learn to land safely
Confidence	Six achievable levels, with a certificate every term and a medal for each level
Listening and discipline	Children follow set routines and instructions, and wait their turn safely
Performance	Routines performed in front of others, building up to a Graduation
Resilience	Practising a skill until it works, then moving on to the next one

Made for every school

- **It's in the national curriculum.** Key Stage 1 asks for balance, agility and coordination. Key Stage 2 asks for flexibility, strength, technique, control and balance, "for example, through athletics and gymnastics". Key Stage 3 asks pupils to develop their technique and improve their performance, again naming gymnastics.
- **Primary and secondary.** NGL Schools covers primary school, and NGL Schools Secondary carries it on through secondary school.
- **Boys and girls take part together**, each at their own level. Nobody sits on a bench waiting to be picked.
- **It runs indoors, all year round.** No pitch, no weather, no cancelled sessions.

Figures: Sport England, Active Lives Children and Young People Survey 2024–25 (December 2025); Department for Education, PE programmes of study.

FROM THE WORLD GOVERNING BODY

"Gymnastics is the foundation of all sports."

Morinari Watanabe, President of World Gymnastics, in his report to the 2026 World Gymnastics Congress, setting out new school curriculum materials so primary teachers worldwide can "teach gymnastics more easily". **NGL Schools does that in British schools today.**
Source: World Gymnastics Bulletin 272, August 2026

A pathway, not a one-off

Most school sport stops when the term ends. NGL Schools is the school stage of **one connected pathway** that a child can follow from pre-school to university and beyond.

Pre-School	First movement skills, at the club
Schools	NGL Schools, in primary and secondary school
Recreational	Weekly club classes, 1–2 hours a week
General League	Competing for the club, 2–10 hours a week
Performance League	11+ hours a week
University League	Gymnastics at university
Masters	Gymnastics for adults



The pathway page in every child's Awards Book

Backed by your local British Gymnastics club

- **Delivered with a local British Gymnastics registered club.** Your pupils get coaching expertise from people who run gymnastics every day.
- **Real gymnastics facilities.** Children can go on to train at the club, with sprung floors, vaults, bars and trampolines.
- **Somewhere to go next.** A child who loves it has a club ready to take them on: weekly classes, then NGL leagues against other clubs.
- **A Graduation at the club.** For many children it's their first visit to a real gymnastics hall.



SECTION 3

School sport funding is changing

The PE and Sport Premium, worth £320m a year, **ends after this school year**. Primary schools have used it for a decade to buy in sports coaching. From April 2027 there are no more direct payments to schools.

Sept 2026	Autumn 2026	Jan 2027	Apr 2027	31 Jul 2027
Ofsted Starts looking at each school's enrichment offer	**Final payment** £6,240 + £10 per pupil, about 40% of a normal year	**New Network** PE and School Sport Partnerships Network starts up	**Support begins** Mostly training and resources; coaching for schools in greatest need	**Deadline** Spend this year's payment and publish your PE report

This year's money can't pay for coaches who cover teachers' planning (PPA) time or teach the existing PE curriculum. It has to make "additional and sustainable improvements" to PE and sport.

Why NGL Schools fits the new model

- **No budget? No problem.** Our after-school option costs your school nothing.
- **Training your own staff is what the funding supports.** Our teacher-led option trains your teachers to run gymnastics themselves, so the skills stay after the money has gone.
- **Ofsted now looks at enrichment.** A gymnastics club with awards, routines and a Graduation is a clear, evidenced enrichment offer.
- **The new Network is built on links between schools, clubs and governing bodies.** NGL Schools already links your school to a local British Gymnastics club.
- **You need to show impact.** Every child's Awards Book records the skills they've passed, and certificates mark progress each term, so you can show progress, not just attendance.

What this means for you

Bought-in coaching paid for by the Sport Premium is ending. NGL Schools gives you a sustainable alternative: either your teachers, trained and supported by the club, or a club-run after-school session that families pay for directly.

Sources: Tes, 21 May 2026; DfE, Primary PE and sport premium conditions of grant 2026 to 2027; DfE letter to schools, 10 July 2026 (via Landscape & Amenity); DfE enrichment framework, 18 June 2026 (via The Key).

SECTION 4

Two ways to run NGL Schools

Your school chooses how it runs the programme. **Either way, children get the same awards, routines and Graduation.**

Option 1 · Teacher-led

Train the trainer · in the school day

- The club trains your teachers to deliver the six levels in PE lessons
- Teachers get the full Teacher Support Pack and routine videos
- A club coach visits every month to support lessons and assess awards
- A small yearly fee to the club, plus Awards Books bought from the club

Option 2 · After-school club

Free to the school · after school

- Club coaches run a weekly gymnastics club in your hall
- Parents book and pay the club directly: no cost or admin for the school
- Working parents get an extra hour of childcare
- Your school gets an enrichment club with clear results

Side by side

	Option 1: Teacher-led	Option 2: After-school club
Who delivers it	Your teachers, trained and supported by the club	Club coaches, on your site
When	In PE lessons	After school
Cost to the school	A small yearly fee, plus Awards Books from the club	Nothing
Cost to families	Optional: Graduation	The club's weekly fee, Awards Book and Graduation
Club support	Training, a monthly visit and a named club contact	Coaches run every session
What stays in school	Teachers who can teach gymnastics with confidence	An enrichment club for Ofsted, with no staff time needed
Best for	Schools that want to build their own PE skills	Schools with no budget, or that want more after-school provision

Option 1 trains your own staff, so it makes the "additional and sustainable" improvement the PE funding asks for. Option 2 needs no budget at all. Many schools will want both.



NGL Schools: Primary Schools

Teachers don't need to be gymnastics experts. **Every skill is set out step by step, every routine is on video, and the club is there to help.**

B **NGL Schools Awards Book**
One per child, six levels. Each child keeps it as a record of the skills they've passed.

M **Medals**
An NGL Schools medal for each level completed, presented at Graduation.

V **Routine videos**
Every routine on video. Families watch at home in the NGL Schools Hub with the club's code.

✓ **Monthly club visits**
A club coach visits every month to support lessons and assess awards (Option 1).

C **Certificates**
Bronze in term 1, Silver in term 2, Gold in term 3, at every level.

T **Teacher Support Pack**
A course overview and a coach's guide for each level, with a picture of every skill.

S **Dedicated club support**
A named contact at your local British Gymnastics club.

G **Graduation**
Children perform their routines for their families, at your local club or at school.

The Awards Book



The cover. Each child's own book



A level page. Floor, bench and vault skills

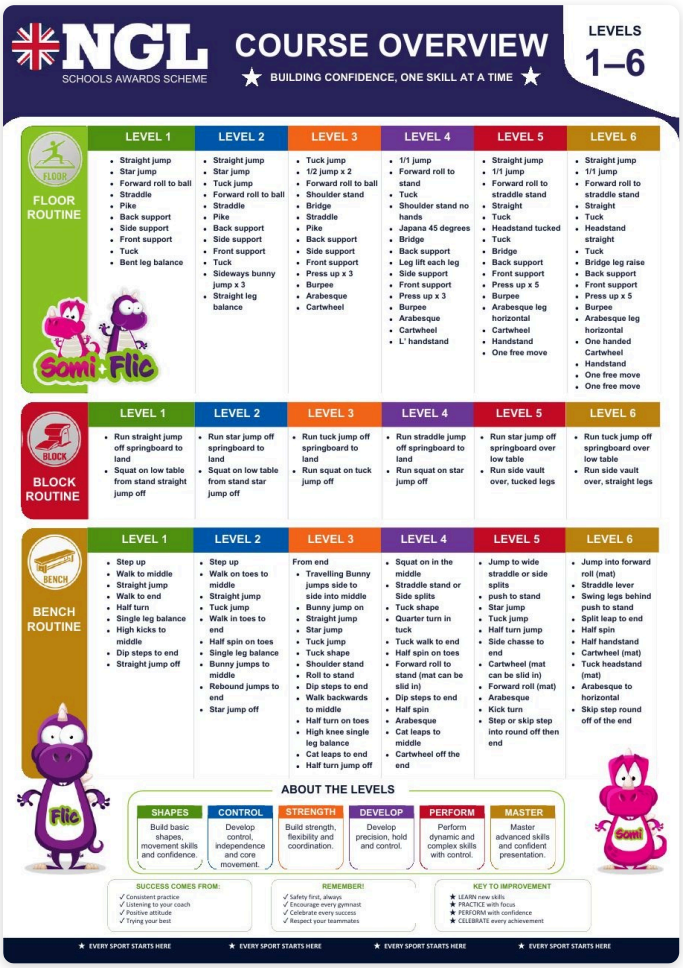


Progress tracker. Bronze, Silver and Gold each term



Congratulations. A medal for each level

The course overview shows every skill in the floor, bench and vault routines for all six levels. **The coach's guide for each level then shows each skill in pictures.**



Course overview. All six levels on one page



Coach's guide, Level 1. Every skill in pictures

The Graduation

When children complete a level, they perform their routines in front of their families, at your local club or at school, and receive their NGL Schools medal.

NGL Schools t-shirt

Children can have their own NGL Schools t-shirt, available through the club.



NGL Schools t-shirt, front and back

Into secondary school

NGL Schools runs in every school, primary and secondary. **When pupils move up from Year 6, NGL Schools Secondary carries the journey on.**

Aligned to the club programme

The same levels and skills clubs teach

- Based on the NGL Recreational programme that clubs run every week
- Levels aren't tied to a school year: pupils work through them at their own pace
- A certificate for every level passed, recorded in each pupil's Awards Book

Built around your equipment

Customised to what your school has

- Floor, vault and beam, adapted to the apparatus in your hall
- No beam? Teachers use a bench and mark the skill as adapted
- Run it the same two ways: teacher-led in PE, or as an after-school club

An optional Performance routine

Each year pupils can take part in an NGL Performance at their local club, performing floor, vault and beam routines in front of family and friends. **These are the same routines gymnasts perform in the clubs' NGL Recreational competitions.**

- **Confidence.** Performing in front of an audience, often for the first time.
- **Preparation.** Learning a routine, practising towards a date and warming up properly.
- **Composure and resilience.** Staying calm under pressure and carrying on after a wobble.
- **A goal for the year.** Something to work towards, and a moment to celebrate.

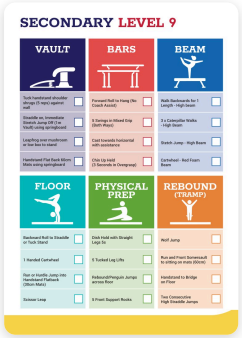
Everything in NGL is connected

Primary school NGL Schools, Levels 1-6 › **Secondary school** NGL Schools Secondary › **Local club** NGL Recreational classes › **Competition** NGL Recreational competitions › **And beyond** General League and more

A pupil who wants to compete their Performance routine simply joins their local club. **They already know the skills and the routine, so the journey continues seamlessly.**



Secondary Awards Book. One per pupil



A level page. The same skills as the club programme



Performance routines. Identical to the Recreational competition

Costs and getting started

NGL Schools can cost your school **nothing at all**, or a small yearly fee if your teachers deliver it.

	Option 1: Teacher-led	Option 2: After-school club
School pays	A small yearly fee, plus Awards Books from the club	**Nothing**
Families pay	Graduation (optional)	The club's weekly fee, an Awards Book and Graduation
Staff time	Teachers deliver it in PE lessons	None

Your local club will give you its prices.

Getting started

1. Choose Option 1, Option 2, or both
2. Meet your local club to agree dates, year groups and the hall
3. The club brings Awards Books, certificates and the Teacher Support Pack
4. Children work through the levels during the year, earning a certificate each term
5. Children perform at their Graduation and receive their medal

Every sport starts here

Talk to your local British Gymnastics club about bringing NGL Schools to your pupils.

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NGL is independent of British Gymnastics and is exclusively for British Gymnastics clubs.